

Simplicity



Is opposed to fleshly wisdom.

2 Corinthians 1:12 For our rejoicing is this, the testimony of our Conscience, that in simplicity and godly sincerity, not with fleshly wisdom, but by the grace of God, we have had our Conversation in the world, and more abundantly to you-ward.

Necessity for.

Matthew 18:2-3 And Jesus called a little child unto him, and set him in the midst of them, 3 And said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the Kingdom of Heaven.

SHOULD BE EXHIBITED

In preaching the Gospel.

1 Thessalonians 2:3-7 For our exhortation was not of deceit, nor of uncleanness, nor in guile: 4 But as we were allowed of God to be put in trust with the Gospel, even so we speak; not as pleasing men, but God, which trieth our hearts. 5 For neither at any time used we flattering words, as ye know, nor a cloke of covetousness; God is Witness: 6 Nor of men sought we glory, neither of you, nor yet of others, when we might have been burdensome, as the Apostles of Christ. ...

In acts of benevolence.

Romans 12:8 Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

In all our conduct.

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Concerning our own wisdom.

1 Corinthians 3:18 Let no man deceive himself. If any man among you seemeth to be wise in this world, let him become a fool, that he may be wise.

Concerning evil.

Romans 16:19 For your obedience is come abroad unto all men. I am glad therefore on your behalf: but yet I would have you wise unto that which is good, and simple concerning evil.

Concerning malice.

1 Corinthians 14:20 Brethren, be not children in understanding: howbeit in malice be ye children, but in understanding be men.

Exhortation to.

Romans 16:19 For your obedience is come abroad unto all men. I am glad therefore on your behalf: but yet I would have you wise unto that which is good, and simple concerning evil.

1 Peter 2:2 As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby:

THEY WHO HAVE THE GRACE OF,

Are made wise by God.

Matthew 11:25 At that time Jesus answered and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.

Are made wise by the word of God.

Psalms 19:7 The Law of the LORD is perfect, converting the soul: the testimony of the LORD is sure, making wise the simple.

Psalms 119:130 The entrance of thy words giveth Light; it giveth understanding unto the simple.

Are preserved by God.

Psalms 116:6 The LORD preserveth the simple: I was brought low, and he helped me.

Made Circumspect by instruction.

Proverbs 1:4 To give subtilty to the simple, to the young man knowledge and discretion. Profit by the correction of others.

Proverbs 19:25 Smite a scorner, and the simple will beware: and reprove one that hath understanding, and he will understand knowledge.

Proverbs 21:11 When the scorner is Punished, the simple is made wise: and when the wise is instructed, he receiveth knowledge.

Beware of being corrupted from that, which is in Christ.

2 Corinthians 11:3 But I fear, lest by any means, as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty, so your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ.

Illustrated.

Matthew 6:22 The Light of the body is the eye: if therefore thine eye be single, thy whole body shall be full of Light.

Exemplified.

David,

Psalms 131:1-2 LORD, my heart is not haughty, nor mine eyes lofty: neither do I exercise myself in great matters, or in things too high for me. 2 Surely I have behaved and quieted myself, as a child that is weaned of his mother: my soul is even as a weaned child.

Jeremiah,

Jeremiah 1:6 Then said I, Ah, Lord GOD! behold, I cannot speak: for I am a child.

Primitive Christians,

Acts 2:46 And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart,

Acts 4:32 And the multitude of them that believed were of one heart and of one soul: neither said any of them that ought of the things which he possessed was his own; but they had all things common.

Paul,

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